

FiiO X1 2nd Gen

Audiophiles everywhere should pay attention to this one. The FiiO X1 2nd Gen is a Hi-Res Audio player that means business. Priced at ₹7,499 this device is not only well designed, it does its job well too. To begin with, the touch wheel included in the player functions very smoothly. Be it browsing through the menu or scrolling through the list of tracks, the touch is very responsive and accurate.

It comes with a 3.5 mm headphone jack can be switched to line output. On the memory department, the FiiO X1 2nd Gen supports a microSD card upto 256GB in size so that you can carry your entire Hi-Res library everywhere you go. And don't worry about the battery running out as the claimed 12 hours of battery life does hold up. It does support the entire range of file formats including APE, FLAC, ALAC,



WAV, WMA, AAC, and MP3 files. An area where it significantly falters is the software and the user interface. Even with the responsive touch and the sleek aluminium body lifting the exterior design up, the menus and UI leave a lot to be desired and appear half hearted designs, not unlike something that one can find in cheap knockoffs. But if you can bear with it, the software does have some very thoughtful features like the ability to choose which button combination stays active even when the device is locked.

At this price point, the FiiO is a value-for-money Hi Res player. You'll definitely notice significant improvement over your typical smartphone output (Yes, you too iPhone 6s users). Bonus tip: the player comes with a case and a few protective films just in case you're the clumsy kind!



Michael Kors MKT5001 Bradshaw

Brands like Huawei, Asus, Sony, Samsung and more have introduced their own Android Wear based offerings in the market. On those lines, the first smartwatch from a major designer is the Michael Kors Access range. We got to play with the Michael Kors Bradshaw (MKT5001) which is priced at around ₹25,000 in India.

The device does satisfy the purpose of an Android Wear smartwatch quite well. The initial connection and syncing with your phone does take its share of time, but once that is done the connection stays almost seamless. Most updates received on your phone show up almost instantly on the watch. In fact, built in speakers let you hear one side of a phone call although you'd still need a blue-tooth microphone connected to your phone to talk. It also has WIFI so it doesn't always need your phone to be connected for updates.

There are two problems with this watch - the size and the display. The display is quite low res at 320x290 and makes the pre-loaded blingy watch faces look pretty washed out. When it comes to the size, this watch is thicker and heavier than your typical smartwatch. However, a host of other features like 5 supported gestures, preloaded replies and music playback have been very well done. If you're ok with a trip to your local watchsmith to get the huge wrist band adjusted, this is a brilliant luxury smartwatch. to go for.